

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1407

By Powell

A RESOLUTION to honor and celebrate the longstanding friendship and partnership between the State of Tennessee and the Federal Republic of Germany.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly find it appropriate to commend those international relationships that have enriched the economic, cultural, educational, and civic life of this State; and

WHEREAS, the State of Tennessee and the Federal Republic of Germany enjoy longstanding and mutually beneficial ties rooted in trade, investment, manufacturing, education, culture, and citizen diplomacy; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee has become a leading destination for international investment and job creation and has actively recruited and supported German investment across the State; and

WHEREAS, German companies represent a substantial source of foreign direct investment in Tennessee, contributing to advanced manufacturing, automotive production, and supply chain development, and supporting thousands of jobs for Tennesseans; and

WHEREAS, the presence of Volkswagen in Chattanooga stands as one of the most visible and impactful examples of the strong economic relationship between Tennessee and Germany, supporting jobs, wages, and tax revenue in Tennessee communities; and

WHEREAS, the people-to-people relationship between Tennessee and Germany has also been strengthened through official sister-city and friendship ties, including, among others, Nashville and Magdeburg, Chattanooga and Hamm, Chattanooga and Wolfsburg, and Franklin/Williamson County and Bad Soden am Taunus; and

WHEREAS, these relationships have fostered student exchanges, professional collaboration, cultural programming, municipal cooperation, and enduring friendships between Tennesseans and the German people; and

WHEREAS, opportunities for collaboration between Tennessee and Germany in workforce development, apprenticeship programs, and higher education partnerships offer meaningful potential to strengthen both economies and prepare the next generation of skilled workers; and

WHEREAS, Tennessee is served by the Consulate General of the Federal Republic of Germany in Atlanta and by an Honorary Consul of the Federal Republic of Germany in Nashville, and German-American business ties in this State are further supported through the German American Chamber of Commerce of the Southern United States; and

WHEREAS, in an increasingly competitive global economy, Tennessee benefits from strengthening ties with trusted democratic allies that share a commitment to innovation, skilled workforce development, advanced manufacturing, entrepreneurship, and long-term economic cooperation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and celebrate the longstanding friendship and partnership between the State of Tennessee and the Federal Republic of Germany and commend the contributions of German businesses, civic institutions, educational partners, and municipal leaders whose work has strengthened Tennessee's economy and enriched the lives of Tennesseans.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we welcome continued cooperation in the areas of trade, advanced manufacturing, automotive innovation, workforce development, education, tourism, and cultural exchange, and celebrate continued dialogue and engagement with

German public and private partners regarding opportunities for deeper cooperation and exchange with the State of Tennessee.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that suitable copies of this resolution be prepared for presentation to the Ambassador of the Federal Republic of Germany to the United States; the Consul General of the Federal Republic of Germany in Atlanta; the Honorary Consul of the Federal Republic of Germany in Nashville; and the German American Chamber of Commerce of the Southern United States.